

KEY

The map shows volcanoes above sea level. Many more volcanoes erupt on the seabed.

**Most lethal****Largest since 1800****Recent volcano**
active since 2006**Other volcanoes,**
either single or in a
cluster of up to six**Europe**

There are few volcanoes in Europe, which is on the Eurasian Plate.

Japan

Part of the Pacific Ring of Fire, Japan has more than 70 active volcanoes.

THERE ARE
ABOUT 1,500
KNOWN ACTIVE
VOLCANOES
ON EARTH

East African Rift

Volcanoes occur here because the African Plate is slowly splitting in two.

Pacific Ring of Fire

Volcanoes are common along the edges of the plates forming the floor of the Pacific Ocean.

Inactive Australia

Australia lies in the middle of a plate and has no active volcanoes.

Most lethal volcanoes

- 1 Mount Tambora, Indonesia, 1815**
Falling volcanic ash destroyed plants and crops, leading to famine. More than 71,000 Indonesians died, the majority from starvation.
- 2 Krakatau, Indonesia, 1883**
The official death toll was 36,417, most of whom died when tsunamis (tidal waves) created by the explosion swept through the region.
- 3 Mont Pelée, Martinique, 1902**
A rapidly moving cloud of glowing gas, ash, and

dust engulfed the town of St. Pierre on the Caribbean island of Martinique, killing all but two of its inhabitants. In all, nearly 30,000 people lost their lives.

- 4 Nevado del Ruiz, Colombia, 1985**
The eruption melted snow and ice on the volcano, creating mudflows that killed about 25,000 people in surrounding valleys.

- 5 Mount Unzen, Japan, 1792**
Some 14,300 people died when, about a month after lava stopped erupting, part of the volcano collapsed in a landslide, triggering a tsunami.